TIMUR KHAZIROV

Senior Technical / Balance Game Designer

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Moscow · Open to relocation or remote · Available immediately

PROFILE

Technical game designer with 5+ years of professional experience on multiplayer and live-service games in Unreal Engine and Unity, and three shipped commercial titles.

I own features from design through release, prototype gameplay in Blueprints and C++, balance combat, progression and economy systems, and work closely with engineering teams.

My technical background lets me build prototypes and internal production tools myself and iterate on gameplay quickly.

Built 50+ mechanics across shipped games and personal projects in C#, C++ and Blueprints.

Lead two junior designers in a team of 10 game designers.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Weapon & combat mechanics • In-engine implementation (Blueprints / C++) • Rapid prototyping & iteration • Systems integration • Vehicle & locomotion prototyping • Design & technical documentation • Cross-department collaboration • Tools & workflow improvement • Mentoring & feedback • Balance & economy • Systemic design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design	Weapon & combat mechanics, gameplay systems integration, rapid prototyping & iteration, vehicle/locomotion prototyping, player progression, economy design, design & technical documentation
Unreal Engine	UE4/UE5, Blueprints, C++ gameplay programming, Gameplay Tags, Enhanced Input, Animation Blueprints, Behavior Trees, AI Controllers, State Machines, Data Tables, Primary Data Assets, NavMesh, Gameplay Debugging
Unity	C#, MonoBehaviour, ScriptableObjects, NavMesh, gameplay implementation & prototyping
Programming	C++, C#, Python
Tools	Git, Bitbucket, Jira, Confluence, Miro, Rider, Visual Studio, Excel / Google Sheets

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Game Designer (Balance / Technical) — GFAGAMES

Nov 2024 — Present

Project: PIONER (Steam, released December 2025) — open-world MMO shooter, Unreal Engine 5; team of ~70

- Owned two features from spec to Blueprints: hip-fire spread with an honest crosshair (spread depends on stance, speed and sustained fire, and the crosshair shows the actual spread) and a full rework of the perk system. Integrated both without breaking existing systems.
- Balance a set of interconnected systems: combat, economy, progression, loot, crafting, vendor pricing; calculated stats for 50+ enemy types, from regular mobs to bosses. In my first ~7 months, a colleague and I rebalanced the entire game. Introduced a weapon power score based on effective TTK and DPS, so weapons work in both PvP and PvE while staying distinct.
- Spotted a grenade readability problem (smoke and damage-zone edges) and got it fixed through a junior designer.
- Built a C++ tool that walks a level and exports every loot spawner (~3,000 on the largest map) with its loot tables and expected item counts to CSV, so loot can be balanced across the whole map in spreadsheets; now used by designers in my department and by level designers.
- Prototype and iterate on weapons, armor, consumables and enemies for live updates, based on internal testing and player feedback.
- Before changing mechanics, dig into the project's Behavior Trees and C++ systems to see how they connect; fix gameplay bugs in Blueprints.

- Write and maintain balance tables and feature specs. Lead two junior designers: set tasks and review design docs; redesigned the friends, chat and clan UX with one of them.
- Work closely with engineers and artists to take new weapons and systems from concept to live content.

Technical Game Designer — 101XP *Mar 2023 — Nov 2024*

Project: The Braves (Steam, released) — live-service action game in the spirit of Vampire Survivors, Unity; team of ~30, 5 game designers

- Wrote 25+ specs for artists and programmers and owned many mechanics (hero skills, weapon behaviors, boss variations) from concept through implementation and balance.
- Built a UI-automation script that moves data from Google Sheets into a browser-only admin panel with no API, making content setup 10× faster.
- Designed gamepad controls for every screen, including a single Sony / Xbox / Nintendo layout table in the spec; the player profile (achievement showcase, frames, avatars) took two design iterations.
- Set up content for live updates, tuned enemy difficulty, rewards and the gacha economy; calculated gacha drop rates for seasonal events.
- Worked daily with programmers, artists and UI artists to ship ongoing live-service content.

Technical Game Designer — 101XP *Dec 2022 — Mar 2023*

Project: Craft of Survival (Google Play, released) — single-player survival RPG, Unity

- First project after moving from QA into design: set up new content for regular updates.
- When support for the project was paused and most of the team left, I was one of two designers who shipped a major unfinished update with a new location: fixed collisions, NavMesh, spawners and the minimap in Unity myself, learning the studio's internal tools on the fly.

QA Specialist (part-time while studying) — 101XP *May 2021 — Dec 2022*

- Part-time while studying: a Random Dice-style PvP tower defense with a short update cycle; in a ~15-person team also coordinated task readiness with programmers and ran and published builds.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

UE5 Helicopter Prototype — Flight model based on real thrust, lift and drag formulas with tunable mass and drag coefficients, plus a nose turret with realistic aim limits and physical projectiles; C++ base classes, Blueprint content. (2025)

Bot Arena (Unity) — Arena shooter against endless waves, inspired by COD: Zombies. Enemy AI with an attack-token queue, state machine and target leading; parameter-driven wave difficulty, three arenas with shops, grenade rocket jump. github.com/KhazirovTimur/BotArena (2023)

Tiny Dozzer (Mobile) — Physics arcade game about a bulldozer pushing cube structures into a moat against the clock: 15 levels in three seasons, icy low-friction levels, explosive barrels; Unity, previously released on Google Play. (2021)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Bauman Moscow State Technical University: Specialist degree (5-year, equivalent to Bachelor's + Master's), Information Security, 2022
- Michigan State University: Introduction to Game Development (Coursera certificate)
- Michigan State University: Principles of Game Design (Coursera certificate)

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Blender (basic) • Adobe Photoshop, Premiere • Basic SFX and music creation • Ableton Live, Reaper

LANGUAGES

Russian: Native | English: C1